

FINANCIAL LITERACY & PERSONAL GROWTH

The Time Traveler's Map: Designing Your 5-Year Financial Future

Grade 6 Session: Learn how to turn your dreams into a destination with a smart 5-year roadmap.

1. Meet Your 16-Year-Old Self

Close your eyes and imagine you are 16 years old. You are likely in Grade 11. What does your day look like? Maybe you need a **professional laptop** for your coding projects, or perhaps you're joining a **coaching class** for your favorite sport or entrance exams.

Your 16-year-old self is counting on the "you" of today! Financial planning is like building a time machine to send resources to the person you will become in 5 years. It starts with a simple plan.

The Life Map Journey

Planning your money is like planning a long family trip from **Kanyakumari to Kashmir**. You need to know your stops (milestones) and how much fuel (money) you need for each leg of the journey.

2. Short, Medium, and Long Term

Not all goals are the same. We categorize them by how much time they take to reach. This helps us prioritize our savings.

Short-Term (1 Year)

Things you want soon.

Example: A new school bag or a birthday celebration.

Medium-Term (3 Years)

Goals that need more time.

Example: A tablet for your studies or a high-end bicycle.

Long-Term (5 Years)

Big dreams that require consistent effort.

Example: A professional Robotics camp or saving for a special hobby in Grade 11.

3. The Samosa Test

Have you noticed that things seem to get more expensive over time? This is because of the **Inflation Monster**.

The Samosa Index

5 years ago, a delicious samosa might have cost ₹10. Today, that same samosa costs ₹15! Even though the samosa is the same, your money buys "less" of it now.

When we plan for 5 years ahead, we have to remember that our target cost will likely grow. If a cycle costs ₹5,000 today, it might cost ₹6,000 when we are ready to buy it. We must save a little extra to beat the monster!

4. Planting Your Money Tree

How do we make sure our money stays strong? There are two main ways to handle your funds.

Saving (Piggy Bank)

Putting money aside in a safe place.
It stays exactly the same size. It's
good for short-term goals.

Investing (Money Tree)

Like planting a mango sapling.
Over 5 years, it grows into a tree
and gives more fruit! Investing
helps your money grow faster than
inflation.

For Grade 6 students, "investing" can be as simple as putting money into a **Post Office Savings Account** or a **Fixed Deposit** with the help of your parents.

5. The SMART Way to Plan

A dream is just a wish until you make it **SMART**. Let's look at how to define your 5-year milestones.

- **S - Specific:** Exactly what do you want? (e.g., "A Robotics Kit," not just "stuff")
- **M - Measurable:** How much does it cost? (e.g., "₹8,000")
- **A - Achievable:** Is it realistic for you?
- **R - Relevant:** Does it actually help your future?
- **T - Time-bound:** When will you get it? (e.g., "In Year 3")

6. Modern & Traditional Habits

India has a rich culture of saving. We can use a mix of old and new ways to reach our 5-year goals.

Traditional Ways

- Gold jewelry
- Post Office Savings
- Cash in "emergency" jars

Modern Ways

- Digital Piggy Banks
- "Family Matching" Plans
- Fixed Deposits

Family Matching: Tell your parents your goal! "For every ₹100 I save from my pocket money, will you add ₹50 to my goal fund?" This is a great way to reach big goals faster.

7. Activity: My 5-Year Treasure Map

It's time to draw your own journey! Use a blank paper to draw a winding path with three major flags.

Milestone 1: Year 1 (Short-term)

What is your goal? | Cost: ₹_____ | Savings source: _____

Milestone 2: Year 3 (Medium-term)

What is your goal? | Cost: ₹_____ | Savings source: _____

Milestone 3: Year 5 (Long-term)

What is your goal? | Cost: ₹_____ | Savings source: _____

8. Why Planning Brings Freedom

Having a 5-year plan isn't about restricting yourself; it's about **freedom**. When you plan, you avoid "money surprises" and you are prepared for the things you truly care about.

Think about the joy of reaching your Year 5 goal. Because you started today, the Grade 11 version of you will have exactly what they need to succeed!

"A goal without a plan is just a wish. A plan turns that wish into a destination."

9. Recap: The Traveler's Map

Congratulations! You've started your journey toward a secure and exciting future.

Session Recap

1. Goals can be **Short, Medium, or Long term**.
2. The **Inflation Monster** makes things cost more over time.
3. **Investing** is like planting a money tree for the future.
4. **SMART** goals and **Family Matching** help you reach targets faster.

You've Completed Session 1!

Keep your Treasure Map safe. Your 16-year-old self is going to thank you!